



Bill Number: S.B. 1798

Sears Floor Amendment

Reference to: EDUCATION S/E Committee Amendment

Amendment drafted by: Leg. Council

FLOOR AMENDMENT EXPLANATION

1. Establishes the Financial Aid Awareness Program (Program) within the Arizona Department of Education (ADE) to recognize Arizona schools that provide financial aid awareness activities and support for completing the Free Application for Federal Student Aid (FAFSA).
2. Directs ADE to collaborate with the Arizona Board of Regents (ABOR) in administering the Program.
3. Replaces the requirements on high schools relating to designating a FAFSA point of contact and providing outlined FAFSA information with an authorization for any school to elect to participate in the Program beginning in the 2027-2028 school year by notifying ADE and demonstrating that the school meets outlined eligibility requirements.
4. Requires ADE to annually determine whether each participating Program school meets the prescribed eligibility requirements.
5. Allows ADE to require each participating Program school to submit reports or other evidence of eligibility to ADE.
6. Allows a participating Program school to include the Program designation in the school's report card and on the school's website, communications and promotional materials.
7. Specifies that the Program eligibility requirement to provide specified FAFSA information to parents and students applies only to schools that provide instruction to high school students.
8. Specifies that a participating Program school must annually report the name and contact information of each FAFSA designated point of contact to ADE in addition to ABOR.
9. Defines *school*.
10. Makes technical and conforming changes.

SEARS FLOOR AMENDMENT
SENATE AMENDMENTS TO S.B. 1798
(Reference to EDUCATION S/E Committee amendment)

Amendment instruction key:

[GREEN UNDERLINING IN BRACKETS] indicates text added to statute or previously enacted session law.

[Green underlining in brackets] indicates text added to new session law or text restoring existing law.

~~[GREEN STRIKEOUT IN BRACKETS]~~ indicates new text removed from statute or previously enacted session law.

~~[Green strikeout in brackets]~~ indicates text removed from existing statute, previously enacted session law or new session law.

<<Green carets>> indicate a section added to the bill.

~~<<Green strikeout in carets>>~~ indicates a section removed from the bill.

1 The bill as proposed to be amended is reprinted as follows:

2 Strike everything after the enacting clause and insert:

3 "Section 1. Title 15, chapter [1] [2], article [1] [2], Arizona
4 Revised Statutes, is amended by adding section ~~[15-120.08]~~ [15-249.20], to
5 read:

6 ~~[15-120.08.]~~ [15-249.20.] Financial aid awareness program;
7 eligibility requirements; annual determination;
8 designation; definitions

9 A. [THE FINANCIAL AID AWARENESS PROGRAM IS ESTABLISHED WITHIN THE
10 DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION TO RECOGNIZE SCHOOLS IN THIS STATE THAT PROVIDE
11 FINANCIAL AID AWARENESS ACTIVITIES AND SUPPORT FOR COMPLETING THE FREE
12 APPLICATION FOR FEDERAL STUDENT AID. THE DEPARTMENT SHALL ADMINISTER THE
13 PROGRAM AND SHALL COLLABORATE WITH THE ARIZONA BOARD OF REGENTS IN
14 ADMINISTERING THE PROGRAM.] BEGINNING IN THE 2027-2028 SCHOOL YEAR, [EACH
15 HIGH SCHOOL] [ANY SCHOOL] IN THIS STATE [SHALL] [MAY ELECT TO PARTICIPATE
16 IN THE PROGRAM BY NOTIFYING THE DEPARTMENT AND BY DEMONSTRATING THAT THE
17 SCHOOL MEETS ALL OF THE FOLLOWING ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS]:

18 1. [DESIGNATE] [DESIGNATES] AT LEAST ONE [SCHOOL] EMPLOYEE AS THE
19 SCHOOL'S POINT OF CONTACT FOR THE FREE APPLICATION FOR FEDERAL STUDENT
20 AID. EACH DESIGNATED EMPLOYEE SHALL:

21 (a) COMPLETE AN INITIAL ORIENTATION PROGRAM FOR THE FREE
22 APPLICATION FOR FEDERAL STUDENT AID THAT IS APPROVED OR RECOGNIZED BY
23 EITHER THE ARIZONA BOARD OF REGENTS OR A FREE APPLICATION FOR FEDERAL
24 STUDENT AID SUPPORT PARTNER. THE DESIGNATED EMPLOYEE MAY RECEIVE
25 CONTINUING EDUCATION CREDITS FOR:

26 (i) COMPLETING THE ORIENTATION PROGRAM REQUIRED BY THIS
27 SUBDIVISION.

1 (ii) COMPLETING ANY TRAINING AND EDUCATION AFTER THE ORIENTATION
2 PROGRAM TO LEARN ABOUT UPDATES TO FEDERAL POLICIES AND PROCESSES RELATING
3 TO THE FREE APPLICATION FOR FEDERAL STUDENT AID.

4 (b) PROVIDE INFORMATION ABOUT THE FREE APPLICATION FOR FEDERAL
5 STUDENT AID, INCLUDING INFORMATION ABOUT AVAILABLE RESOURCES AND
6 ASSISTANCE, TO STUDENTS AND FAMILIES OF STUDENTS.

7 2. ~~ANNUALLY [REPORT]~~ [REPORTS] TO THE ARIZONA BOARD OF REGENTS [AND
8 THE DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION] THE NAME AND CONTACT INFORMATION OF EACH
9 EMPLOYEE WHO IS DESIGNATED PURSUANT TO PARAGRAPH 1 OF THIS SUBSECTION.

10 3. ~~[INCLUDE]~~ [INCLUDES] THE NAME AND CONTACT INFORMATION OF EACH
11 EMPLOYEE WHO IS DESIGNATED PURSUANT TO PARAGRAPH 1 OF THIS SUBSECTION IN
12 THE STUDENT HANDBOOK AND IN AT LEAST ONE COMMUNICATION FROM THE SCHOOL TO
13 STUDENTS AND PARENTS OF STUDENTS.

14 4. ~~[POST]~~ [POSTS] THE NAME AND CONTACT INFORMATION OF EACH EMPLOYEE
15 WHO IS DESIGNATED PURSUANT TO PARAGRAPH 1 OF THIS SUBSECTION ON THE
16 SCHOOL'S WEBSITE.

17 5. ~~[DEVELOP]~~ [DEVELOPS] AND ~~[IMPLEMENT]~~ [IMPLEMENTS] A FREE
18 APPLICATION FOR FEDERAL STUDENT AID AWARENESS STRATEGY THAT IS ALIGNED
19 WITH EDUCATION AND CAREER ACTION PLAN REQUIREMENTS ADOPTED BY THE STATE
20 BOARD OF EDUCATION. [IF THE SCHOOL PROVIDES INSTRUCTION TO HIGH SCHOOL
21 STUDENTS,] THE STRATEGY THAT IS DEVELOPED PURSUANT TO THIS PARAGRAPH MUST
22 PROVIDE, THROUGH THE SCHOOL'S MESSAGING SYSTEM, SOCIAL MEDIA ACCOUNTS,
23 EMAIL ACCOUNTS AND STUDENT INFORMATION SYSTEM PORTAL, THE FOLLOWING
24 INFORMATION IN GRADE-LEVEL COMMUNICATIONS TO STUDENTS IN EACH OF GRADES
25 NINE THROUGH TWELVE:

26 (a) THE PURPOSE OF THE FREE APPLICATION FOR FEDERAL STUDENT AID.

27 (b) THE BENEFITS OF COMPLETING THE FREE APPLICATION FOR FEDERAL
28 STUDENT AID.

29 (c) THE ROLE OF FINANCIAL AID IN POSTSECONDARY EDUCATION AND CAREER
30 PATHWAYS.

31 6. ~~[PROVIDE]~~ [IF THE SCHOOL PROVIDES INSTRUCTION TO HIGH SCHOOL
32 STUDENTS, PROVIDES], THROUGH THE SCHOOL'S MESSAGING SYSTEM, SOCIAL MEDIA
33 ACCOUNTS, EMAIL ACCOUNTS AND STUDENT INFORMATION SYSTEM PORTAL, THE
34 FOLLOWING INFORMATION TO THE PARENTS OF STUDENTS WHO ARE IN GRADE TWELVE:

35 (a) THE IMPORTANCE OF COMPLETING THE PARENT OR CONTRIBUTOR PORTION
36 OF THE FREE APPLICATION FOR FEDERAL STUDENT AID.

37 (b) ANY SCHOOL-BASED OR STATEWIDE SUPPORT THAT IS AVAILABLE FOR
38 COMPLETING THE FREE APPLICATION FOR FEDERAL STUDENT AID.

39 (c) ANY RELEVANT DEADLINES OR RESOURCES.

40 [B. THE DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION SHALL ANNUALLY DETERMINE WHETHER
41 EACH SCHOOL THAT ELECTS TO PARTICIPATE IN THE PROGRAM MEETS THE
42 ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS PRESCRIBED BY SUBSECTION A OF THIS SECTION. THE
43 DEPARTMENT MAY REQUIRE PARTICIPATING SCHOOLS TO SUBMIT REPORTS OR OTHER
44 EVIDENCE OF ELIGIBILITY IN A FORM AND MANNER PRESCRIBED BY THE DEPARTMENT.

45 C. A SCHOOL THAT ELECTS TO PARTICIPATE IN THE FINANCIAL AID
46 AWARENESS PROGRAM AND THAT MEETS THE ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS, AS
47 DETERMINED BY THE DEPARTMENT PURSUANT TO SUBSECTION B OF THIS SECTION, MAY

1 INCLUDE THE FINANCIAL AID AWARENESS PROGRAM DESIGNATION IN THE SCHOOL
2 REPORT CARD REQUIRED BY SECTION 15-746 AND ON THE SCHOOL'S WEBSITE,
3 COMMUNICATIONS AND PROMOTIONAL MATERIALS.]

4 [~~B.~~] [D.] FOR THE PURPOSES OF THIS SECTION[.] [~~—~~]

5 [1.] "FREE APPLICATION FOR FEDERAL STUDENT AID" MEANS THE
6 APPLICATION THAT IS REQUIRED BY 20 UNITED STATES CODE SECTION 1090 FOR
7 INDIVIDUALS SEEKING TO APPLY FOR FEDERAL FINANCIAL AID.

8 [2. "SCHOOL" MEANS A SCHOOL THAT IS OPERATED BY A SCHOOL DISTRICT
9 OR CHARTER SCHOOL.]"

10 Enroll and engross to conform

11 Amend title to conform

KIANA SEARS

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C: VS

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